

L E S S O N 20

Learn to Study the Bible Like a Pro

8: Studying the Bible

Scripture Focus: 2 Timothy 2:15 · 2 Peter 1:20-21

Studying the Bible is both an art and a science. Sound interpretation means reading Scripture literally, accounting for historical, grammatical, and cultural context, and trusting the unity of God's Word. The basic principles are Observation (what does it say?), Interpretation (what does it mean?), and Application (how should I respond?). With practice, every believer can become skilled at understanding God's Word.

BY THE END

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to 2 Timothy 2:15 and 2 Peter 1:20-21.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

VOCABULARY

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Interpretation	The disciplined work of understanding what Scripture means before applying it to life.
Faith	Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Word	So, what we want to do in the next two videos is talk about how to study God's word.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see Learn to Study the Bible Like a Pro from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. Studying the Bible is both an art and a science. Sound interpretation means reading Scripture literally, accounting for historical, grammatical, and cultural context, and trusting the unity of God's Word. The basic principles are Observation (what does it say?), Interpretation (what does it mean?), and Application (how should I respond?). With practice, every believer can become skilled at understanding God's Word.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

2 Timothy 2:15 and 2 Peter 1:20-21 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. In other words, that we can be as the passage says, approved workers, those that are doing good for our God.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. Many new believers find it difficult to understand what the Bible is saying. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

2 Timothy 2:15

2 Timothy 2:15 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read 2 Timothy 2:15 first, then read 2 Peter 1:20-21. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

In other words, that we can be as the passage says, approved workers, those that are doing good for our God.

Study the passage:

1. *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
2. *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*

3. *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*

FRAMEWORK

A Framework for Learn to Study the Bible Like a Pro

BIBLICAL EMPHASIS	COMMON DRIFT
Begin with Scripture and let it define the issue.	Begin with instinct, feeling, or cultural assumptions.
Connect doctrine to worship and obedience.	Keep doctrine as information only.
Practice one concrete response this week.	Agree with the truth without changing any habit.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does Learn to Study the Bible Like a Pro most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. Many new believers find it difficult to understand what the Bible is saying. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. A parent contradiction should lead us to deeper study and comparison with other passages. Biblical teaching should train

the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Learn to Study the Bible Like a Pro belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. Daily life in biblical times was very different than from today. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Learn to Study the Bible Like a Pro should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **So, since God is truthful and all scripture is inspired by him, we can trust its consistency.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about learn to study the bible like a pro?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about learn to study the bible like a pro. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use 2 Timothy 2:15 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
